

Outdoor / Balcony / Backyard Interview

Practice Questions

(answer truthfully; don't guess if unsure).

1) Outdoor space overview

- Do you have an outdoor space (balcony, porch, patio, backyard, shared yard)?
- Is it private to your unit or shared with neighbors/other tenants?
- Where is it located (off the living room, off the bedroom, back door, front porch)?
- How do you access it (sliding door, regular door, stairs)?

2) Doors, locks, and how it opens

- What type of door leads outside (sliding glass, hinged door)?
- Does it lock? Where is the lock/latch located?
- Do you keep it locked most of the time or only at night?
- Any screen door? How does it open (slide/swing) and does it latch properly?

3) Patio/balcony/backyard furniture

- What outdoor furniture do you have (chairs, table, bench, couch)?
- How many seats are there?
- What color/material is the furniture (metal, wicker, plastic, wood)?
- Do you have cushions? What color/pattern? Where are they stored when it rains?
- When and where did you get the furniture (store/online/second-hand) and about when?
- Who paid for it or who picked it out?

4) Grill and cooking outside (if applicable)

- Do you have a grill? What type (gas/charcoal/electric)?
- Where is the grill located (balcony corner, patio near door, backyard)?
- Who uses the grill most often?
- What do you usually grill (a couple real examples)?
- Where do you keep grill tools (tongs, brush) and fuel (propane/charcoal)?
- How often do you grill (weekly, summer only, rarely)?

5) Plants and gardening details

- Do you have plants outside? How many?
- Are they in pots, planters, hanging baskets, or garden beds?
- What kinds of plants (flowers, herbs, vegetables) (describe what's actually there)?
- Who waters them most often and how often?
- Where is the watering can/hose kept?
- Any plant you're especially proud of or any that died recently?

6) Decor and outdoor items

- Any outdoor decor (string lights, lanterns, wind chimes, rugs, flags)?
- Do you have an outdoor rug/mat? What color/pattern?
- Any storage box, deck bin, or shed? What's stored inside?
- Do you keep bikes, strollers, or sports gear outside? Where exactly?

7) Trash bins and recycling outside

- Where are outdoor trash bins located (side of house, behind building, near driveway)?
- Do you have separate bins for trash and recycling?
- What color/size are the bins (if you know)?
- Who takes trash/recycling out to the bins?
- When are bins brought to the curb (pickup day/time) (if known)?
- If shared dumpster: where is it and who/when empties it (if known)?

8) Maintenance and who takes care of it

- Who maintains the outdoor space (you, spouse, landlord, landscaping crew)?
- What do you do yourselves (sweeping, watering, snow shoveling, weeding)?
- How often do you sweep/clean the balcony/patio?
- If there's a yard: who mows the lawn or rakes leaves?
- In winter: who handles snow/ice and where do you keep salt/shovel?

9) Neighbors and shared-space rules (if shared)

- Are there rules about grills, noise, or hours?
- Do you share the yard with neighbors? Who uses it most?
- Any assigned outdoor area or seating?
- Any recent issues (noise complaints, pets, trash) and how was it handled?

10) Pets and outdoor use (if applicable)

- Do you let pets outside? Where do they go (yard/balcony only)?
- Any pet items outside (water bowl, toys, leash hook)?
- Where do you keep bags for pet waste (if applicable)?

11) Outdoor routine and how you use the space

- How often do you use the outdoor space (daily, weekends, summer only)?

- What do you usually do out there (coffee, relaxing, phone calls, meals)?
- Who uses it more often?
- Do you eat outside? If yes, what do you typically eat and where do dishes go after?

12) “Reality check” questions (recent and specific)

- When was the last time you sat outside and what did you do?
- What was the last thing you cleaned or moved outside?
- Any recent purchase for the outdoor space (plant, chair, lights)? Who bought it?
- When was the last time trash/recycling was taken out and by who?
- Did you grill recently? What did you cook and where were supplies stored?

Tip: If you're not sure about a detail, it's better to say “I don't remember exactly” than to guess.